Björn Thor Arnarson

ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit · Ny Kongensgade 6, DK-1472 Copenhagen K, Denmark
bth@rff.dk · bjorn.thor.arnarson@gmail.com · +46 733 314 065
www.bjornthorarnarson.com · Citizenship: Icelandic, Swedish

Employment and Affiliations

Researcher, *ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit* — June 2025–
Affiliated Researcher, *Department of Economics, Lund University* — 2025–
Affiliate, *CESifo* — 2024–
Affiliated Research Fellow, *Economic Policy Research Unit (EPRU)* — 2017–

Previous

Assistant Professor, *University of Copenhagen* — May 2021–Sep 2026
Marie Skłodowska-Curie Research Fellow, *University of Copenhagen* — Jan 2019–May 2021
Research project BRIDGE, financed by the EU's Horizon 2020 programme
Post-doctoral Researcher, *University of Copenhagen* — Jan 2017–Jan 2019
Financed by a grant from the Innovation Fund. Focus on export promotion
Affiliated Researcher, *Centre for Öresund Studies, Lund University* — 2017–2025
Post-doctoral Researcher, *Lund University* — Oct–Dec 2016
Earlier Positions, *Reykjavik* — 2007–2011
Chief Economist, Iceland Chamber of Commerce (full-time), Dec 2009–2011; Researcher, Institute of Economic Studies (part-time), 2009–2011; Business Journalist, Fréttablaðið (summers only), 2007 and 2008

Paternity leave: 7 months (16 weeks in 2018–2019, 15–29 April 2018, and 1 March to 21 May 2019) and 3 months during PhD studies (part-time work).

Education

PhD in Economics, Lund University, Sweden — 2011–2016
MA in Economics, Boston University, USA — 2008–2009
BS in Economics, University of Iceland, Iceland — 2005–2008
Exchange student in Economics, University of Oklahoma, USA — 2006–2007

Pedagogical Training

Teaching and Learning in Higher Education (UCPH) — 2021–2022
Final project: Open and Unstructured Assignment in International Economics
University Teaching and Supervision Course for Academic Staff — 2021

Publications

Globalization and the Gender Gap in Mental Well-being. *Journal of International Economics* (2026), vol. 161, pp. 104253. (with A. N. David, B. S. Javorcik and J. R. Munch).
Linking Local Services to Global Manufactures. *The Scandinavian Journal of Economics* (2022), vol. 124(1), pp. 3–34. (with Joakim Gullstrand).

How a School Holiday Led to Persistent COVID-19 Outbreaks in Europe. *Scientific Reports* (2021), vol. 11, pp. 24390. *(single-authored)*.

The Superstar and the Followers: Intra-Firm Product Complementarity in International Trade. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* (2020), vol. 177, pp. 277–304. *(single-authored)*.

The Paternity Leave Act in Iceland: Implications for Gender Equality in the Labour Market. *Applied Economics Letters* (2010), vol. 17(7), pp. 677–680. (with Aparna Mitra).

Working Papers and Work in Progress

Growing Together and Apart: Scale Economies and Labor Specialization in Global Value Chains (with Magnus T. Buus, Andreas Moxnes, Jakob R. Munch and Chong Xiang). *R&R, Journal of Political Economy*.

CESifo Working Paper 12710

R&D Employment and Transmission in Trade and MNE Networks: Evidence from an R&D Tax Reform (with Magnus T. Buus, Jakob R. Munch and Georg Schaur).

ROCKWOOL Foundation Study Paper 217

Knowledge Spillovers from Cross-Border Commuters: Evidence from a Natural Experiment (with Jakob R. Munch, Morten G. Olsen and Emil A. L. Simonsen).

ROCKWOOL Foundation Study Paper 215

International Spillovers from Supplying Superstars: Evidence from Firm-to-Firm Linkages (with Jonas Slaathaug Hansen).

The Intangible Gains from Trade (with Martina Magli and Andreas Moxnes).

Bridging Trade Barriers: Evaluating Multi-Product Models of Exporting *(single-authored)*. *Dormant*.

Working Paper 2015:6, Lund University, Department of Economics

Book Chapters and Monographs

Omstilling på Arbejdsmarkedet: Globalisering, Automatisering og Uddannelse. Syddansk Universitetsforlag, Odense, 2023 (with J. R. Munch, A. N. Christensen, D. Hémous, A. Humlum, B. Javorcik, B. B. Meyer, M. Olsen, P. Plato, M. Rasmussen and E. Vestergaard).

Exports and Externalities. Doctoral thesis, Lund University, November 2016. Opponent: Andreas Moxnes.

Grants

ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit grant, *Disruption and Structural Change: Challenges and Opportunities in the Labor Market* (DKK 9.6m; Joint PI with Jakob Munch) — 2024–2028

ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit grant, *Labor Market Effects of Automation, Offshoring and Multinationals* (USD 1,200,000; co-recipient; PI: Jakob Munch) — 2019–2023

Seed financing, Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen (DKK 40,000; sole applicant) — 2020

Seed financing, Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen (DKK 62,000; sole applicant) — 2019

Marie Skłodowska-Curie grant, project BRIDGE, *Labour Market Integration: Consequences of Cross-Border Commuting*. EU Horizon 2020, grant no. 79367 (DKK 1.58m; sole applicant) — 2018

EPRN network project grant, *The Labour Market Effects of the Öresund Bridge* (DKK 330,000; sole applicant) — 2017

Handelsbanken project grant, *Local Conditions and Global Firms* (SEK 1.5m; co-applicant) 2016

Conference and travel grant, Stiftelsen Siamon 2015, 2016

Travel grant, Stiftelsen för Främjande av Ekonomisk Forskning 2014, 2015, 2016

Teaching

Lecturer (course responsible), Advanced International Trade (MSc), *University of Copenhagen* Fall 2021–2023

Supervision of five MSc and two BSc students

Teaching assistant, *Lund University* 2012–2016

Introductory Macroeconomics, International Trade and Introductory Microeconomics (undergraduate); Economic Integration and Advanced Trade Theory (MSc)

Instructor, *Reykjavik University* 2010–2011

Lecturer, Introductory Macroeconomics; teaching assistant, Applied Statistics (undergraduate)

Research Visits

LMU Munich July 2026

CESifo, Munich July 2024

Conferences and Invited Seminars

2026: RMET (Banff); DIEW (Aarhus); Scientific Workshop on Productivity, German Council of Economic Experts and DIW Berlin (Berlin); ETSG (Exeter); ROCKWOOL Foundation Annual Internal Workshop (Berlin); OECD LIFT seminar, Paris (scheduled).

2025: Swedish Network for European Studies in Economics and Business (SNEE); invited seminar, ROCKWOOL Foundation Research Unit.

2024: NOITS (Oslo); SNEE (Lund); CESifo Area Conference on the Global Economy.

2023: Invited seminar, Icelandic Economists Abroad conference (University of Iceland); EPRN Copenhagen; SNEE (Lund).

2021: Invited seminar for Business Sweden.

2019: Road to Exporting, Copenhagen.

2018: Moscow International Economics Conference (Moscow); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); SNEE (Lund).

2017: Empirical Investigations in Trade and Investment, Yogyakarta (FREIT); invited seminar, Örebro University; NOITS conference (Helsinki); LETC conference (Slovenia, FREIT); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); SNEE (Lund).

2016: Invited seminars at the University of Copenhagen and IFN Stockholm; NOITS (Oslo); ADI Conference (Copenhagen); Lund University; ETSG (Helsinki); Summer School on Urban Growth and Agglomeration (Barcelona); Summer School on Economic Modeling and Inference (Aarhus).

2015: ETSG (Paris); Summer School on Panel Data Methods, Jeffrey Wooldridge (Thessaloniki); NOITS (Copenhagen); GEP Postgraduate Conference (University of Nottingham); Lund University; Danish International Economics Workshop (Aarhus); invited seminar, Sydsvenska Handelskammaren (Malmö).

2014: ERSA Summer School; NOITS conference; Nordic Summer Symposium in Macroeconomics; Lund University; ETSG.

Professional Service

Conference organization: organizer of the NOITS conference, Copenhagen 2025 and Iceland 2021, and web coordinator of the network homepage (www.noits.org). NOITS is the annual Nordic conference in international economics.

Refereeing: American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; Economic Journal; European Economic Review; European Review of Economic History; Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization; Scandinavian Journal of Economics; Review of International Economics; Review of World Economics; Economics of Innovation and New Technology; The International Trade Journal; Technological Forecasting & Social Change; Rannís (the Icelandic Research Fund).

Policy Work and Other Writing

"Trump og tollar: Fórn á við margfalda íslenska verðmætasköpun – ár eftir ár?" *Vísbending*, May 2025.

The Road to Exporting (RoadtoExporting.dk): lead designer of the research-backed policy website, with Jakob Munch and Georg Schaur. Financed by the Innovation Fund. Site sunset in 2026.

Four commissioned reports for the *Institute of Economic Studies, University of Iceland*, on Icelandic agriculture and EU accession and on the economic impact of the Harpa concert hall, with Dadi Mar Kristofersson and Sveinn Agnarsson, 2010–2012.

Five reports for the *Iceland Chamber of Commerce* on business conditions, business taxation and capital controls, and main editor of the status report on the Icelandic economy, 2010–2011.

Languages

Icelandic (native), English (fluent), Swedish (fluent), Danish (intermediate).